

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 6 5
 ♥ 9 8 4 3
 ♦ K Q 10 5 2
 ♣ 6

♠ A 10 7 2

♥ K Q

♦ 9 8 4

♣ K Q 8 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 4 3
 ♥ 10 7 6 2
 ♦ J 7 6
 ♣ 9 5 3

♠ K J 8

♥ A J 5

♦ A 3

♣ A J 10 7 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	4 ♣	Pass	6 ♣
All Pass			

6 ♣ by South
a ♠ loser from your hand.

The slam was easy to bid, now you just have to make it. South plays 6 ♣. West leads the ♦ Q.

You have one certain ♦ loser, and a two-way finesse for the ♠ Q. That should make you start thinking about elimination and throw-in. So win the ♦ A and pull trumps, West having a singleton.

Now eliminate ♥s from your hand and dummy by playing ♥K, ♥A, ♥J. **BUT BE CAREFUL!** On the ♥J you must discard a ♦ from dummy so both of you will be out of ♦s at the throw-in.

NOW you can execute the throw-in. Play your ♦, which eliminates ♦s from both you and dummy and at the same time throws in one of the defenders. Whoever it is will be forced to lead a ♠ and eliminate your guess for the ♠ Q or else give you a ruff-sluff, allowing you to ruff in dummy and discard

Among Bridge players you often hear about someone (usually Aunt Harriet) who is amazingly lucky at guessing the location of missing Queens.

Perhaps Aunt Harriet isn't that lucky after all, perhaps she just knows how to perform elimination plays.

Hopefully in the future you will be the one with the reputation!

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 9

♥ K Q J 8 7 4 2

♦ 9

♣ 10 4

♠ 10 7 5 4 3

♥ A 3

♦ A 6 5

♣ K 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ -

♥ 9 6

♦ K Q J 10 8 7

♣ Q J 9 7 2

♠ A K 8 6 2

♥ 10 5

♦ 4 3 2

♣ A 8 5

West

North

East

South

4♥

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by South

1♠

Play your ♠A, the ♦A and the ♣AK. West follows to everything.

You've done all you can do. Now play the ♥10 to West's high ♥.

West has just won his side's first trick with the ♥J. He now plays the ♠Q, winning his side's second trick.

Now, West is still on lead, and he has nothing in his hand but good ♥s. So he leads one of them, and you **DO NOT RUFF**. Instead you discard a ♣ from dummy and a ♦ from your own hand. West has now taken his side's third trick. He plays another good ♥, and you ruff in dummy and discard the last ♦ loser from your hand. You can now cross-ruff for the rest of the tricks.

Incredible isn't it.

You just wonder how many bridge players would have just conceded down 2 on this hand.

Not you or me, of course.

When the bidding gets high in a hurry you sometimes have to guess what you can make. South plays 4♠. West leads the ♥K.

And it looks like you are too high. Assuming the trumps split 2-1, you still have one ♥ loser, two ♦ losers and one ♣ loser.

You win the ♥A and play a ♠ to your ♠K. East discards a ♦!

From bad to worse. Now you must add a ♠ loser to the four you already had. Are you finished?

No, never give up. West has a bunch of ♥s and 3 ♠s, so he cannot have many ♦s and ♣s. If you can eliminate those and then throw him in it should work to your advantage.

Board 5

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 6
 ♥ K 8 2
 ♦ K Q 10 3 2
 ♣ 10 8 6 4

♠ A 10 9 3
 ♥ 7 5 4
 ♦ A J 6
 ♣ Q 7 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8 5
 ♥ J 10 9 6
 ♦ 9 8 7 4
 ♣ J 9 2

♠ K Q J 7 4 2
 ♥ A Q 3
 ♦ 5
 ♣ A K 3

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♥	Pass	6 ♠
All Pass			

6 ♠ by South

small ♥ from your hand. West wins his ♦ Q (which his opening lead told you he held) and is end-played. He must lead a ♥ to your tenace or give you a ruff-sluff.

The answer to the question posed above is:

It is a pretty simple problem, but you are no doubt getting a lot better.

North's 3 ♠ is a limit raise, 11-12 points in support of ♠s. When you discover that the raise includes two Aces you bid the slam. South plays 6 ♠. West leads the ♦ K, won by you with dummy's ♦ A.

Is this a really easy elimination play showing up this late in the group? Or are you just getting better at seeing them? In any case, you should see that a successful ♥ finesse will land your contract, but you should also remember that there aren't many finesses working on these 25 deals.

So rather than finesse, eliminate! Pull trumps in two rounds, ending in dummy.

Ruff the ♦ 6, then play ♣ A, ♣ K, ♣ Q.

So here you are in dummy. Do you finesse the ♥ now? Of course not. You play the ♦ J and discard a